MICHELLE PALINKAS

Fortune 500 Global Creative Manager | Creative Direction and Multimedia Storytelling

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SUMMARY

Award winning Fortune 500 creative leader with 20+ years in 3D, animation, film and brand. I lead global Creative Services for Corning Optical Communications, pairing creative strategy and brand governance with hands on creative technology: Unreal Engine real time rendering, engineering model reuse, scripting and AI tools. Winner of a Gold ADDY and two Silver Telly Awards for The Optical Frontier. Past work for ESPN, Electronic Arts and PBS.

AWARDS AND SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Gold ADDY Award (2026) and two Silver Telly Awards (2025)** for The Optical Frontier, a film I wrote and directed for Corning's 2025 Kickoff Conference, establishing the look and feel, creating early animatic shots, directing the VO artist and leading the production team. Telly categories: Craft, Fully Animated Piece and General, Sizzler/Promo Reel.
- **170K+ YouTube views** for the GlassWorks AI launch film I directed and storyboarded, including 95K in its first two months.
- **$100M+ in revenue supported** by the renders and animation I guided for the global launch of Next Gen FlexNAP and Multifiber Pushlok.
- **70 to 90% faster renders** after securing clearance for Unreal Engine and moving the multimedia team to real time rendering on PCs.
- **Complex models from 35 to 40 hours down to about 8** through an engineering model reuse pipeline built with teams in Poland and North America.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Global Creative Manager
Oct 2021 to Present

Corning Optical Communications
Charlotte, NC

Corning is a global Fortune 300 company; Optical Communications develops fiber optic cable, connectivity and solutions for telecom, data center and enterprise networks.

- Lead Creative Services for a portfolio of about 250 products. Directly manage an internal creative team of 8 and coordinate external production partners and teams in Mexico and Poland, 25+ people in all.
- Own global brand approval: 1,945 reviews through October 2026, up 15.9% on all of 2025, while fast track requests rose from 14% to 22% of volume.
- Team shipped 3,176 pieces of creative in 2025, including 1,040 renders, 991 social images, 537 pieces of collateral, 518 product photos and 90 videos.
- Earned 97.6% creative satisfaction in 2026 (96% in 2025), with 99% of stakeholders confirming final files arrived when needed.
- Delivered creative for the Bring Broadband Home campaign launch (2023 to 2024).
- Provide creative direction for AI infrastructure launches, strategic customer communications, executive presentations, the 2025 Investor Relations Day and the Kickoff Conference core team.
- Set Creative and Marketing Services standards for CAD2Catalog, a multiyear PIM transformation that brings standardized, reusable product renders into the product design workflow.
- Introduced a Maya to Substance to After Effects workflow (75 to 80% faster renders), Adobe AI tools (about 97% time savings on major edits) and Flipsnack interactive publications.
- Challenged a rendering software price increase and worked with vendors, Procurement and Finance to keep production running without interruption.
- Every eligible team member earned a Recognizing Excellence award in 2025 and 2026; coaching took one designer from 47% to 100% on time delivery. Run the Creative Initiative program of art shows, concerts and museum visits.
- Selected and planned the 2026 multimedia internship, which produced a reusable Unreal material library, a standard preview render process and an organized 3D asset library.

Senior Multimedia Specialist
Dec 2018 to Oct 2021

Corning Optical Communications
Charlotte, NC

- Created 3D renders, animation, motion graphics, product demo videos and interactive Ceros experiences for marketing and internal communications.
- Designed 10+ interactive web experiences, including a 3D rotating interactive trade show booth during the pandemic.

- Cut modeling time on complex cable visuals by 77 to 80%.
- Wrote a Python tool using Maya hair to generate 3D fibers, cutting data center cable build time by 50%.
- Standardized product renders with a shared KeyShot studio file and Photoshop clipping path action; trained external vendors on materials, lighting and render setup.

Course Director, 3D Character Design and Creation
May 2011 to Oct 2017
Full Sail University
Winter Park, FL

- Designed and taught the Character Design and Creation curriculum in Maya and ZBrush, guiding 40 to 50 students a month in an accelerated program.
- Created a live lecture format for online students, recognized by the Head of Online Learning; supervised and mentored two lab specialists.
- Partnered with a Python developer on a grading tool that cut grading time from days to 2 to 3 hours.

Assistant Art Director
Oct 2012 to Oct 2013
ESPN
Orlando, FL

- Directed a team of three 3D modelers creating 3D printed set models for broadcast design, working with directors and producers on set integration.

Earlier Experience

Maya Generalist, Outpost 21 Studios (2013) · Associate Modeler, Electronic Arts (2009 to 2010) · Graphic Artist and 3D Modeler, Agi Agi Studios (2006 to 2008) · 3D Modeler, Mihn Kieu Architectural Design (2005 to 2006) · Associate 3D Director, MG Studios, including character design and animation for PBS (2003 to 2005)

SKILLS

Leadership: Creative strategy, brand governance, team leadership, partner coordination, coaching, budgets and vendors, production pipelines, workflow automation, trade show design

Tools: Unreal Engine, Maya, ZBrush, Substance, KeyShot, RenderMan, XGen, After Effects, Premiere Pro, Final Cut Pro, Audacity, Photoshop, Illustrator, Ceros, Flipsnack, Python

AI tools: Runway, Seedance, Adobe Firefly, Claude, ChatGPT

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Computer Animation, Full Sail University
Associate of Science, Computer Animation, Full Sail University
Associate of Arts, Valencia College